

An addendum to the syllabus - Might answer some questions or might not. Must be read with a sense of humor.

This is not required reading, but might provide some insight to your professor and help you with the Syllabus Quiz.

Q: What is the meaning of life?

A: 42

Q: Why?

A: <https://www.livescience.com/diophantine-42-solved-meaning-of-life.html> and other reasons

Q: How do you debug code?

A: Start with print statement, try walking through the code with a debugger, create a simpler version of the code that still has the same problem. You should not post your full code to discord and expect others to debug it for you, but posting a simplified version to discord (or stackoverflow), explaining what is expected and what is not working would also be a good start.

Q: I have a question about the class what should I do?

A: Depends. Is the information in the syllabus? Have you read the syllabus? Start by asking a friend. Maybe try asking on discord in case other people have a similar question. If none of these work, you can try office hours or emailing your professor. For some type of questions QSC or other UWB resources may also be appropriate.

Q: Can I get points back on the assignment?

A: Depends. Has it been marked incorrectly? Do the points not add up as you expect them? You cannot get points because you "worked really a lot" on the assignment, but you might ask to have it regraded if you think the grader (or your professor) has not marked it correctly. Asking via email is the first step, followed by going to office hours to discuss it. You should ask for a regrade as soon as possible. Asking for a regrade of homework-1 at the end of the quarter is not a good idea.

Q: Can I change my course to S/NS grading?

A: Yes, but for core CSS courses you need a decimal grade, so only change it to S/NS if you are not doing well in the course and do not want the bad grade impacting your GPA.

Q: Can I drop the course?

A: Depends. You might have special requirements due to financial aid or being an international student. There are specific deadlines for dropping a course or using your Annual Drop option. Check the information from Registrar for details.

Q: Who do I need to talk to about registration issues

A: CSS Advisors. In almost all cases, CSS Advisors maintain waiting lists, can see which student really needs the course to graduate and can provide Add Codes.

Q: Can you email me my grade?

A: No

Q: Why not?

A: UW Policies with respect to email not being private.

Q: Where can I see my grade?

A: Canvas

Q: When do I get my Final grade?

A: Usually, professors have to submit final grades by Tuesday 5pm the week after finals week.

Q: Can you grade my Final earlier?

A: No

Q: What is the difference between email and Canvas message?

A: You can send an email to anybody that has an email address, but Canvas is restricted to sending messages to people who are in your courses. For email, there are lots of programs (Outlook, Eudora, pine, Gmail, etc) that you can use. Canvas messages have to go through Canvas. While Canvas messages can be forwarded to external systems, they still have to go through Canvas.

Q: What is the difference between a Canvas message and Canvas submission comment?

A: A submission comment is a "comment" on a specific homework or submission. It can be viewed as a set of comments under that specific submission by graders, professor and possibly team mates. A Canvas message is usually sent to one person and is sent privately to that person. Others do not have access to it.

Q: Can I use my hotmail address instead of UW address?

A: No. For the purposes of communicating with your professor, always use your UW email address. Your UW email address is a valuable asset. You should use it when applying for jobs, on your resume, on your web page etc to take advantage of UW's prestige and your association with it. You can still forward your UW email to your personal one, but set it up so that when sending an email you can switch between your UW email and personal one. For Gmail, this is under Settings > Accounts and Import. For example, I have +10 different email addresses. I use my personal one and UW one most often, but the other addresses also come in handy at times. Did you know that emails sent to netid+anyword@uw.edu will still be delivered to netid@uw.edu? Comes handy when you need a second email address to test things out.

Q: LinkedIn, Facebook, Instagram, WhatsApp, discord, Telegram, iMessage ... Which one should I use?

A: For class discussion, I often use discord. Professional connections are on LinkedIn. You can connect to your professors on LinkedIn which will let you connect to other UWB alumni in different companies. Facebook and Instagram are more on the personal side, so I usually do not connect to students on those platforms. WhatsApp and iMessage is usually reserved for people that I might call on the phone, not students. There is no hard rule as different people use these platforms differently.

Q: Can I put my course work on a public web page?

A: No. Assignments often get reused. Let's not tempt future students by having the answer on a web page. You can submit your code samples to your potential employers via email, put them on a password protected web page or a zip file in Google Drive (or Dropbox) that is shared with specific people.

Q: While trying to understand how to use a specific function, I found a 'neat sample'. Can I use it as part of my assignment?

A: If it is a short snippet of code, as in 5-10 lines, you can use it in your code as long as you provide a reference to the URL in your comments. If you are searching for assignment solutions and submitting a modified version of somebody else's assignment, that would be considered plagiarism.

Q: Is there an assigned seat for exams?

A: Not usually, but I might ask you to move to another seat so everybody has a bit of space to themselves.

Q: How often does cheating in exams happen?

A: Very very rarely. It is a serious offense with serious consequences. It does not happen often. Occasionally, a student submits a copy of somebody else's assignment or something from the internet. The automated tools are really good at detecting patterns, so it is often detected and punished.

Q: What resources can I bring to the exam?

A: I often allow for 1 letter-sized, double-sided sheet with hand-written notes. No microscopes or magnifying glass. You are responsible for crating your own cheat sheet. No buying miniaturized textbook and lecture notes from the internet ;-). If hand-writing is a problem for you, talk to me and we can make alternate arrangements.

Q: Can I leave the exam as soon as I am done?

A: No. While you might be done, other students are probably feeling the time pressure and trying to finish the exam in the remaining time. Continuous stream of students getting up and leaving is distracting for those students. I will set specific exit times, often at 1 hour into the exam for early finishers and then at 1:30 and 1:45 for a 2-hour exam. If you are done early, spend the time to check on your answers, meditating or solving puzzles (can you set 8 queens on chess board without them taking each other,

how about a knight visiting each of the 64 squares of the chess board without revisiting?). Think of this extra time as a courtesy to your classmates who are struggling.

Q: Can I have my lunch during the exam?

A: No. Exam time is for the exam. Think of it like SAT, GRE and other standardized exams. Focus on the exam. If you leave the room, you cannot come back and continue the exam, so best to visit the toilet beforehand. In the past, I have had students consuming way too much liquid during exam and having to make multiple toilet visits. Best to keep things simple. If a 2-hour fast presents a problem for you, please talk to DRS to make special exam arrangements.

Q: Can I have my lunch during class?

A: You can have food as long as you are not taking extra space or eating foods that everybody around you can smell (which can be distracting to others). Eating nuts, power bar, piece of chocolate etc is fine, but the classroom is not the place to setup your lunch table for soup and salad combo.

Q: Does UW provide any special discounts on Amazon?

A: Not to my knowledge

Q: Can I ask you on how to install software?

A: Only after you have exhausted all the options. Talk to your friends, reach out to others on discord, visit UW-IT at the library, search the internet forums and after having done all that you are still having problems, come and ask me. I love helping resourceful students that are genuinely trying to solve a problem.

Q: Was there anything important in the last class I missed?

A: No. In fact, since you could not make it to class, we decided to cancel it (that was sarcasm in case you missed it). The lectures are a learning opportunity. If you choose not to take advantage of this opportunity, you do not have the right to have the lecture repeated or summarized for you. Talk to friends, check out if the lecture notes are posted, check if there is Panopto recording of the lecture, do the readings from the syllabus and do your best to understand the material. After all that, if you still have questions about the content, come to the office hours with specific questions.

Q: How quickly do you respond to emails?

A: I try to respond within 2-3 days, but sometimes emails pile up and it takes me longer to respond. If I have not responded to your email after 1 week, send me a reminder.

Q: What is an acceptable reason for missing an exam?

A: Serious illness, bereavement (death or loss of a family member), an unforeseen event such as traffic accident, or official university business.

Q: What is DRS?

A: Disability Resources for Students (DRS) <https://www.uwb.edu/studentaffairs/drs>
University of Washington is a commitment to ensuring access to a quality higher education experience for a diverse student population. DRS provides academic accommodations are provided to students with disabilities.

Q: Can I be on my computer during lecture?

A: Only if it is related to current class activity. Make the best of the lecture time, focus on the material being discussed.

Q: Is this class hard?

A: It is hard for some students, easy for others. For a 5cp course, you should expect to work a total of 15 hours per week on average including lecture hours. For some students, this will be as high as 20 or 25, for others it might be 5 hours. It is only average and expect it to vary through the quarter.

Q: Do I have to attend classes?

A: You do not get "credit" for attendance and you will not be penalized for not attending. However, if you miss an in-class exercise, you will get 0 for that exercise.